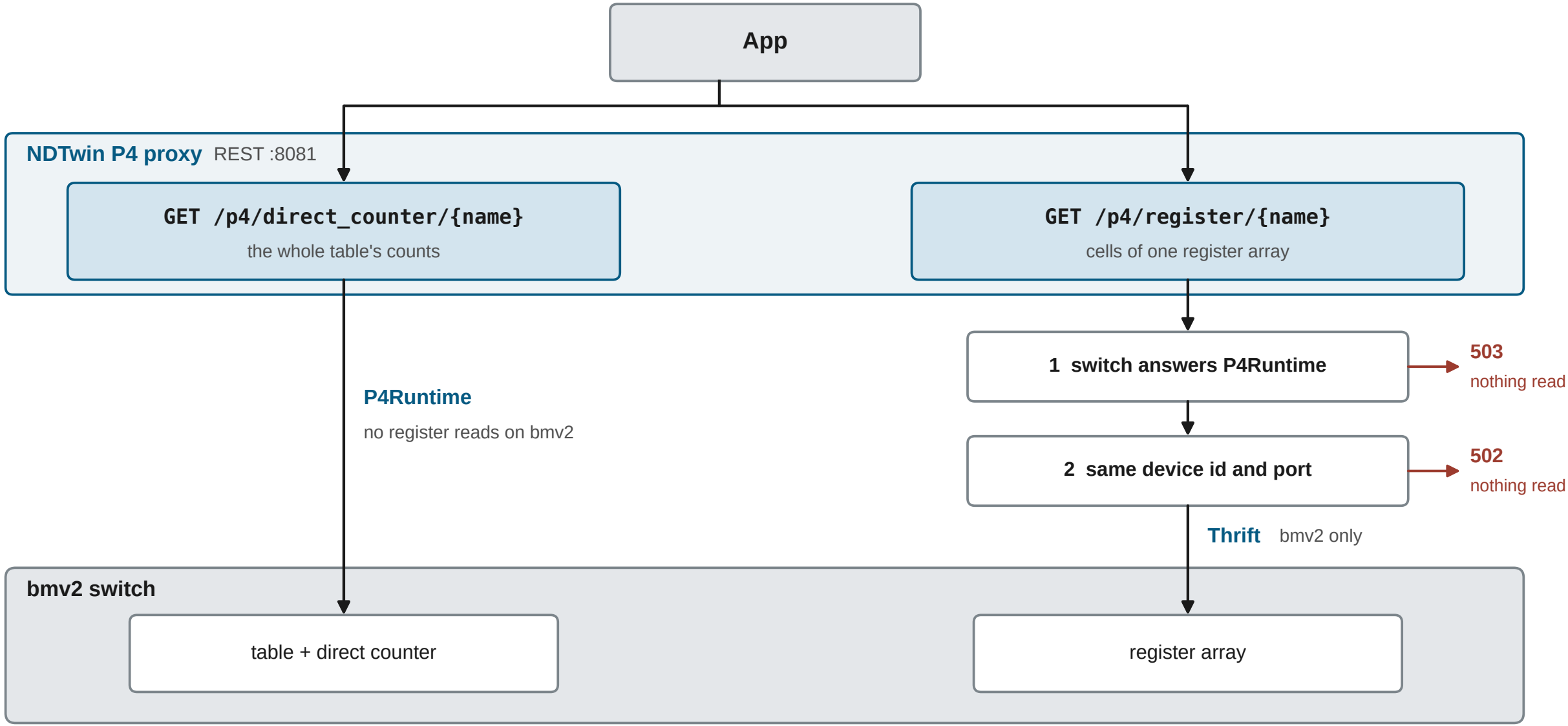Reading registers and direct counters